the period of the 1960s and 1970s) was a temptation that was difficult to resist and was therefore exploited, whether or not it was justified.

Intelligence collection officers, who were taught that the intelligence product of their work was the reason for their existence, witnessed a regression and the creation of a new form of status based on their recruiting talent rather than the quality of the intelligence they produced. I see in this a distortion of priorities, in which more importance is attributed to a skill that is a tool than to the ultimate goal— the intelligence for which the organization you serve exists. In light of this, during my period as director of the Mossad, the method I employed was based on approving the inclusion of MI analysts for meetings with sources only in those cases where it was justified, and not as a matter of norm and routine.

Since the 1950s, reality has changed almost beyond recognition, and with it the threats facing the State of Israel. We, the members of the community, and the entire nation of Israel, should be proud that all of the branches of the intelligence community have adapted to these changes surprisingly quickly with respect to the training of human resources, technological tools, and doctrines of warfare.

Beginning in the mid-1970s, the Mossad was charged with the additional task of thwarting hostile activities, namely global terrorism, in Target Countries and in the Base Countries. In the late 1970s, the Mossad also began to take on the responsibility of thwarting the buildup of nonconventional weapons by Israel's enemies. As a result of these tasks, for which the Mossad was involved in both intelligence gathering and prevention, there grew a vital need to develop research and assessment capabilities in these two areas within the Mossad; this was how the regime in which Military Intelligence was the sole body for research and assessment in the community began to change.

The annual intelligence assessment was—and still is—the peak of the community's intelligence work throughout the year. From the establishment of the state until the recommendations of the Agranat Commission, formed following the Yom Kippur War in 1973, it was agreed by all that MI was the national intelligence assessor of the State of Israel. MI's research division was the national clearinghouse to which all raw intelligence produced by any party in the country flowed. The IDF Intelligence Corps was not only an investigator and an assessor but an independent intelligence producer in all fields of intelligence, which continued to grow until it reached the